



*And so to Ragnarök: the twilight of the gods
and their inescapable doom.*

Odin's efforts to stave off Ragnarök had failed, and the Aesir turned to face their deaths bravely. It was the Norns who brought about this unavoidable fate. First came Fimbulvetr, a winter that lasted for three years. The Sun's warmth faded, and blinding snow swirled from the East, West, North and South. Ice crackled up from the earth – a white net, strong as iron, covered every surface. Freezing fog seeped through windows. All the hearths went out, never to be lit again. Darkness descended like a breaking wave, and death arrived.

Harvests failed, fruit trees withered, animals perished, and the people began to starve. They wandered the land with pale, pinched faces and skinny limbs, driven to steal and even kill for a scrap of food.

*Families and friends turned on one another. Nothing existed
except fear and the brutal struggle to survive.*

In the heavens above, the ravening wolves Sköll and Hati finally caught up with their prey, and with jaws agape swallowed whole the Sun and the Moon. People wailed and fell to the ground. The stars blinked out, leaving nothing behind but a black void.

Yggdrasil, the tree that held the cosmos together, trembled and shook. Leaves, bark and branches fell and were carried away on the howling wind. The ground rumbled, lava spurted forth, and all the mountains crumbled into dust. But worse was still to come.